

AI Collaboration & Development Log

Personal Portfolio Website — Aravind Duraisamy

Purpose of This Document

This log documents the use of Claude (Anthropic) as an AI development assistant in building the personal portfolio website at `Aravind_Duraisamy_Portfolio.html`. It is provided in the interest of transparency and professional ethics, so that anyone reviewing this work — an employer, an academic reviewer, or Aravind himself at a later date — has an accurate record of what was AI-assisted, what was human-directed, and what content is factually sourced from Aravind's own history rather than generated or invented.

Ownership and Authorship

All factual content on the site — work history, dates, award names, project descriptions, education, skills, and contact information — was supplied directly by Aravind Duraisamy or retrieved from his own prior conversations with Claude. Claude did not invent biographical facts. Claude's role was limited to: (1) implementation — writing the HTML, CSS, and JavaScript that renders the design; (2) copywriting — drafting sentence-level phrasing of the summary and section copy based on facts Aravind provided; and (3) design decisions — color palette, typography, layout, and animation choices, made under Aravind's direction and revised on his feedback throughout.

Summary of What Was Built

- A single-file, self-contained HTML/CSS/JavaScript portfolio site (no build step required), styled in a blueprint/drafting theme reflecting Aravind's project-management focus.
- A Three.js wireframe hero animation and a canvas-based particle grid background, both performance-tuned to pause when off-screen or when the browser tab is hidden.
- An experience timeline, project showcase (6 real projects), and a skills/tools section, all populated from Aravind's actual resume history and prior conversations with Claude.
- An embedded professional photo (base64-encoded directly into the HTML for portability).
- A gold-accented visual highlight treatment for Aravind's two workplace recognitions (Certified People's Success x3, Best Employee of the Month x2).
- A decorative, single-instance animated "dino runner" divider (in the style of the offline Chrome dinosaur game) placed once, immediately before the Contact section.
- Subtle interface sound effects (hover/click tones) generated via the Web Audio API, with a mute toggle.
- An AI chat widget ("Ask about Aravind") intended for visitors to the deployed site, backed by a serverless function (`api/chat.js`) that calls the Anthropic API server-side so the API key is never exposed in the browser. The widget's knowledge base is restricted to facts listed in this same document's source history and is instructed not to invent personal details.
- Deployment packaging for Vercel (`package.json`, `api/` folder, and a `DEPLOY_INSTRUCTIONS.md` file) since the AI chat widget requires a serverless backend that static hosts like GitHub Pages cannot provide.

Iterative Revision History

The site was built iteratively across a single extended session, with Aravind reviewing each change and directing the next. Key revisions included:

- Initial build of the full site structure, copy, and blueprint design system.
- Addition of Aravind's professional photo, later corrected from a display bug (relative file path) to an embedded, portable format; subsequently re-cropped and later replaced with an updated photo.
- Correction of employment date ranges and merging of a duplicated job entry, using dates confirmed in an earlier resume-building conversation with Claude.
- Addition of a second education entry (B.E. Mechanical Engineering) and expanded skills chips (Excel/VLOOKUP, CRM systems, Nexus banking CRM, Level 3 technical support, documentation) based on details Aravind provided directly.
- Removal of a placeholder GitHub link at Aravind's request, pending his real GitHub username.
- Addition and later reduction of a decorative animation (dino runner) from six instances to one, following Aravind's own observation that six felt repetitive.
- Performance optimization pass: removed a costly blur effect from repeated project cards, reduced particle-grid density and frame rate, and paused the 3D hero animation when scrolled out of view, in response to Aravind noticing dropped frames while scrolling.
- Rewrite of the hero summary paragraph for stronger narrative voice, at Aravind's request for more creative, professional copy.
- Reduction of vertical spacing between page sections by half, at Aravind's request.

Outstanding Items (as of this document)

- GitHub username not yet added (link currently omitted from the live site).
- resume.pdf file not yet supplied; the download button will not function until this file is added alongside index.html.
- The AI chat widget requires deployment to Vercel (or an equivalent serverless host) and an ANTHROPIC_API_KEY environment variable to function; it will not respond on GitHub Pages or when the HTML file is opened locally without a backend.

Disclosure Statement

Aravind Duraisamy used Claude (Anthropic) as an AI coding and design assistant in the development of this website. Claude generated code, layout, and draft copy under Aravind's direction; Aravind supplied all factual content, reviewed all output, and directed all revisions. This document is intended to support honest disclosure of AI assistance in professional or academic contexts where such disclosure is expected or required.

Generated by Claude (Anthropic) at Aravind Duraisamy's request, as a record of the development session. Delivered as a companion document alongside the portfolio website files.